

August 2026

Dear Raanan,

I've worked in Orinda long enough to know that hill-view singles on generous lots don't come along often, and when 136 Ardith Dr. hit the market this spring, the combination of that panoramic hillside view, the wide-plank hardwood floors, and the single-level layout made it one of the more compelling listings I'd seen in the Ivy Drive neighborhood in a while. So when I noticed it came off the market after just 19 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out.

Nineteen days is a short run, but in Orinda's current environment, 19 days without an accepted offer on a home priced at \$959 per square foot tells a story worth examining. At that price point, buyers are comparing carefully, and the listing description, while enthusiastic, never quite built the case for the number. The view was mentioned, but the experience of standing in that open-plan living space with light streaming through expansive windows across 18,320 square feet of lot was never translated into something a buyer could feel before they drove out for a showing.

I've put together a short packet that walks through three specific reasons I think the listing didn't convert, and what a repositioned strategy would look like for this home. It's not a pitch, it's an honest read of what the data shows and what I'd do differently.

If you're already working with a real estate agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside, no hard feelings at all. If you're not, I'd genuinely welcome a conversation, even just to compare notes on the market.

With respect,



Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

136 Ardith Dr.

Orinda, CA 94563

4.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 1,975 Sq Ft · Orinda

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 136 Ardith Dr.

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Single-Level Hill-View Home with a Rare Open Floor Plan - and a Listing That Didn't Show It

136 Ardith Dr. has the ingredients Orinda buyers at this price point are actively searching for: a single-level layout on an 18,320-square-foot lot, panoramic hill views captured through expansive windows, a 10-foot island kitchen with walk-in pantry, wide-plank hardwood floors, and a bonus room that functions as a home office or gym. In a market where buyers routinely sacrifice lot size or single-floor living for the right school district, this home offers both, walkable to 12 years of Orinda's top-ranked schools. These are not incidental features. They are the reasons a buyer pays a premium.

At \$1,895,000 and \$959 per square foot, the pricing placed this home at the upper tier of the Orinda range, which is a defensible position given the view, the lot, and the condition of the renovation. The listing ran 19 days before coming off market without a sale. That short window, combined with a listing description that leaned on enthusiasm rather than evidence, suggests the marketing never closed the gap between what this home offers and what the number requires buyers to believe. When premium pricing isn't backed by premium storytelling and distribution, qualified buyers hesitate, and hesitation in a 19-day window doesn't recover.

\$1,895,000

List Price

\$959/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch here needs to accomplish one specific thing: give serious buyers the visual and narrative evidence to justify \$959 per square foot before they walk through the door. The view, the lot, the single-level plan, and the renovation quality are all there. They just need to be shown, not told.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: The View Was Mentioned, But Never Experienced Online

The listing description called the hillside view 'stunning' and 'mesmerizing,' which is the kind of language that sounds good in person and reads as filler online. At \$959 per square foot, buyers comparing this home against others in the \$820-\$950 Orinda range need to feel the difference before they commit to a showing. A panoramic hill view captured through expansive windows in a single-level open floor plan is exactly the kind of asset that converts browsers into appointments, but only if the photography and aerial context give it room to land. Standard MLS angles against a front elevation don't accomplish that.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour places the home in its full lot and hillside context, giving buyers the aerial perspective that ground photography simply can't replicate, and that's often what turns a digital browsing session into a showing request.

Friction #2: Premium Pricing Without the Case Built to Support It

At \$959 per square foot, this home sits at the upper boundary of the Orinda premium tier. That's a position the lot size, view, single-level plan, and renovation quality can absolutely support, but only if buyers understand specifically what they're getting at that number that they can't find elsewhere in the market. The listing described features accurately but didn't connect them to value. A buyer scanning Orinda inventory sees the price, compares it against a handful of other options, and without a clear narrative explaining the premium, they default to caution. That caution is what a 19-day window without an offer looks like.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Zillow Showcase placement pairs premium visual presentation with narrative content directly on the listing page, so buyers encounter the case for the number at the exact moment they're forming their opinion, not after.

Friction #3: Passive Distribution in a Selective Buyer Market

In 2026, buyers at the \$1.9 million level in Orinda are not browsing casually. They are active, informed, and comparing a short list of properties with real precision. A standard MLS approach, regardless of how well-prepared the listing itself is, waits for those buyers to arrive rather than putting the home in front of them while they're still forming their list. The Ivy Drive neighborhood and the school access story are especially relevant to buyers currently living in San Francisco or Oakland who are beginning to research Lamorinda, often months before they've identified a specific property. That audience wasn't reached.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork runs geo-targeted digital campaigns aimed at SF and East Bay buyers who are actively researching Lamorinda, reaching them before they've found what they're looking for, rather than after they've already built a short list without this home on it.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	136 Ardith Dr.	Orinda Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$959/sqft	Orinda premium tier: \$900–\$1,000/sqft
Lot / Setting	18,320 sq. ft. lot, panoramic hill views	Typical Orinda lot: 8,000–12,000 sq. ft.
Architectural Character	Single-level open plan, 1959 build, extensively renovated	Mixed; multi-level plans dominate standard inventory
Premium Features	10-ft island kitchen, wide-plank hardwood floors, hill view, bonus room, no HOA	Standard floor plan; HOA common in comparable communities
HOA	None	Varies; \$150–\$400/mo common in HOA communities

The verdict: At \$959/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$900–\$1,000/sqft, this home sits in the middle of that range. At \$959 per square foot, this home is priced at the middle of the Orinda premium tier, and the lot size, hill views, single-level plan, and renovation quality give it a legitimate case for that position. What the listing history suggests is that the marketing didn't build that case clearly enough for buyers comparing at this level, not a pricing problem, but a presentation and distribution gap that a repositioned strategy can address directly.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Make the View the First Impression, Not a Caption

The panoramic hill view and the light it creates inside that open-plan living space are the most persuasive things about this home, but only if buyers experience them before they arrive. A relaunch would lead with aerial Sky Tour footage and cinematic interior photography timed to the natural light the listing description describes so well. Buyers should feel the view before they schedule a showing, not discover it when they walk in.

Pillar II - Build the Narrative That Justifies the Number

At \$959 per square foot, every detail of this home, the 18,320-square-foot lot, the single-level plan, the 10-foot island, the hardwood floors, the bonus room, the proximity to 12 years of top-ranked schools, needs to be presented as part of a connected story, not a checklist. Buyers at this price point want to understand exactly what they're getting that they can't find elsewhere. We build that case in the listing remarks, the property micro-site, and the Zillow Showcase page before the first showing request comes in.

Pillar III - Reach the Buyers Who Are Still Deciding Where to Look

The most qualified buyers for a home like this, families relocating from San Francisco or Oakland who want top schools, single-level living, and a real lot, are often still in the research phase when the right listing fails to find them. BrightWork's geo-targeted campaigns run in those markets while buyers are forming their short list, not after it's been finalized. Combined with placement on our off-market private buyer list at offmarket.brightworkrealty.com, a relaunch here starts with a warmer audience than a standard MLS reset would reach.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

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The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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